

SARAH FRITZ

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🌐 <https://sarahfritziwh.github.io/sarahfritz/>

EDUCATION

Martin Luther University Halle-Wittenberg, Halle (DE) April 2020 - present
PhD Candidate in Economics
Supervisors: Prof. Dr. Christoph Wunder, PD Dr. Mirko Titze

Università Commerciale Luigi Bocconi, Milan (IT) Sept. 2017 - Dec. 2019
M.Sc. in Economic and Social Sciences

Università Commerciale Luigi Bocconi, Milan (IT) Sept. 2016 - June 2017
Exchange Program: ERASMUS +

Sciences Po Paris, Franco-German European campus, Nancy (FR) Sept. 2014 - Aug. 2017
Bachelor equivalent (with Distinction)
Trilingual studies in European politics and institutions, Economics, European History, Law

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Halle Institute for Economic Research (IWH), Halle (DE) Feb. 2020 - January 2026
Researcher at the Centre for Evidence-based Policy Advice

University of Essex, Colchester (UK) November 2023
Visiting scholar

University of British Columbia (UBC), Vancouver (CA) Spring 2022, Spring 2023
Visiting PhD student

Halle Institute for Economic Research (IWH), Halle (DE) July 2018 - Sept. 2018
Student research assistant in the Department of Structural Change and Productivity

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Public Economics, Labor Economics, Applied Microeconomics

RESEARCH

Reshaping the Economy? Local Reallocation Effects of Place-Based Policies (JMP) – draft available [here](#)
with [Catherine van der List](#) (University of Essex)

We study the effects of place-based policies on aggregate productivity using administrative data on the universe of projects co-financed by the EU in Italy linked to firm balance sheet data. We exploit quasi-experimental variation in EU funding for a large place-based policy stemming from measurement error in regional GDP estimates. Results show that the program decreases labor productivity of areas receiving investments. Decomposing the change reveals that the aggregate productivity declines are driven by reallocation of labor to low-productivity firms, particularly in the manufacturing sector. Analysis of the mechanism using firm-level event studies reveals that the negative labor reallocation effects are caused by high-productivity firms taking up the funds and subsequently becoming more liquidity constrained, leading to slowdowns in employment growth.

Declining Free Lunch: State Capacity and Foregone Public Spending – draft available [here](#)
with [Lorenzo Incoronato](#) (University of Naples Federico II) and [Catherine van der List](#) (University of Essex)
Revise & Resubmit at *Journal of Urban Economics Insight*

A Helping Hand, But Not a Lift. EU Cohesion Policy and Regional Development – draft available [here](#)
with [Eva Dettmann](#) (IWH)
Revise & Resubmit at *Economic Analysis and Policy*

TEACHING

Martin Luther University Halle-Wittenberg, Halle (DE)

September 2020 - March 2024

Instructor at the School of Economics and Business

Principles of Economics (Bachelor level)

Latest evaluation: 1.4 (excellent)

Martin Luther University Halle-Wittenberg, Halle (DE)

April 2020 - August 2023

Instructor at the School of Economics and Business

Evidence-based Policy Advice (Bachelor and Master level)

Latest evaluation: 1.5 (excellent)

POLICY WORK

Policy notes

The causal effect of EU fiscal transfers on public support for the European Union
with [Mirko Titze](#) (IWH)

2024

Projects

Participation in the interdisciplinary project “[The Rise of Populist Parties in Europe:
The Dark Side of Globalisation and Technological Change?](#)” funded by the Volkswagen Foundation.

2020-2024

AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

Summa cum Laude (top 2% of students), Sciences Po Paris (all campuses)

2017

Scholarship German Academic Scholarship Foundation

2014-2019

PRESENTATIONS, CONFERENCES AND SEMINARS

2025: 14th European Meeting of the Urban Economics Association (UEA), Workshop on Empirical Microeconomics (WEM-Halle), 2nd Verona Early Career Workshop in Economics, Berlin Network of Labor Market Research (BeNa) Summer Workshop, 59th Annual Meetings of the Canadian Economics Association (CEA), 18th and 19th Workshop on Empirical Microeconomics and Applied Econometrics, 40th meeting of the European Economic Association (EEA), Conference on Regional Economic Inequalities, Verein für Socialpolitik (VfS) Annual Conference 2025, 40th Italian Association of Labour Economics Conference (AIEL)

2022-2024: 62nd and 63rd European Regional Science Association (ERSA) Congress, UBC Vancouver School of Economic Urban Lunch Seminar, UBC Vancouver School of Economic Labor Lunch Seminar, 14th and 16th Workshop on Empirical Microeconomics and Applied Econometrics

OTHER

Software Stata, R, $\LaTeX$, GitHub, MS Office

Languages German (native), French (native), English (fluent), Italian (advanced)

(updated May 2026)